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INSTITUTIONS IN MYANMAR'S 2015 ELECTION

The Election Commission, International Agencies, and the Military

Chaw Chaw Sein

Myanmar successfully held an historic general election on 8 November 2015 under President U Thein Sein's government. Local people as well as the international community welcomed the election outcome, where the National League for Democracy (NLD) won by a landslide, with 77.1 per cent of seats nationwide. The ruling Union Solidarity and Development Party (USDP) won only 117 seats out of 1,150, or 10.2 per cent of the total.

In the pre-election period, some people assumed the election would not be free and fair. Even though by-elections had been held successfully on 1 April 2012 and had brought members of the NLD to parliament, they pointed to general mistrust of the Union Election Commission (UEC), as